Episode 1: The House of Mourning (ផ្ទះបុណ្យ)

Full Game Design & Narrative Specification Document

1. Overview & General Info

- **Title:** ***Boon Sop:*** *The Unbroken Debt — Episode 1: The House of Mourning*
- **Time Period:** 1932 (French Protectorate Era in Cambodia)
- **Protagonist:** Sora (□□□□□□□ - Age 24) – A graphic designer/illustrator living alone in her Phnom Penh studio, returning to her rural roots after a sudden tragedy.
- **Location:** Family Estate, Rural Village, Battambang Province, Cambodia
- **Estimated Playtime:** 3 to 4 Hours
- **Genre:** 3D First-Person Atmospheric Survival Horror
- **Engine Target:** Babylon.js / PlayCanvas (WebGPU/WebGL native in-browser)
- **Visual Aesthetic:** 1930s film grain, high-contrast chiaroscuro lighting, sepia-tinted shadows, PBR teak wood, wet mud reflections, and flickering oil flame shadows.

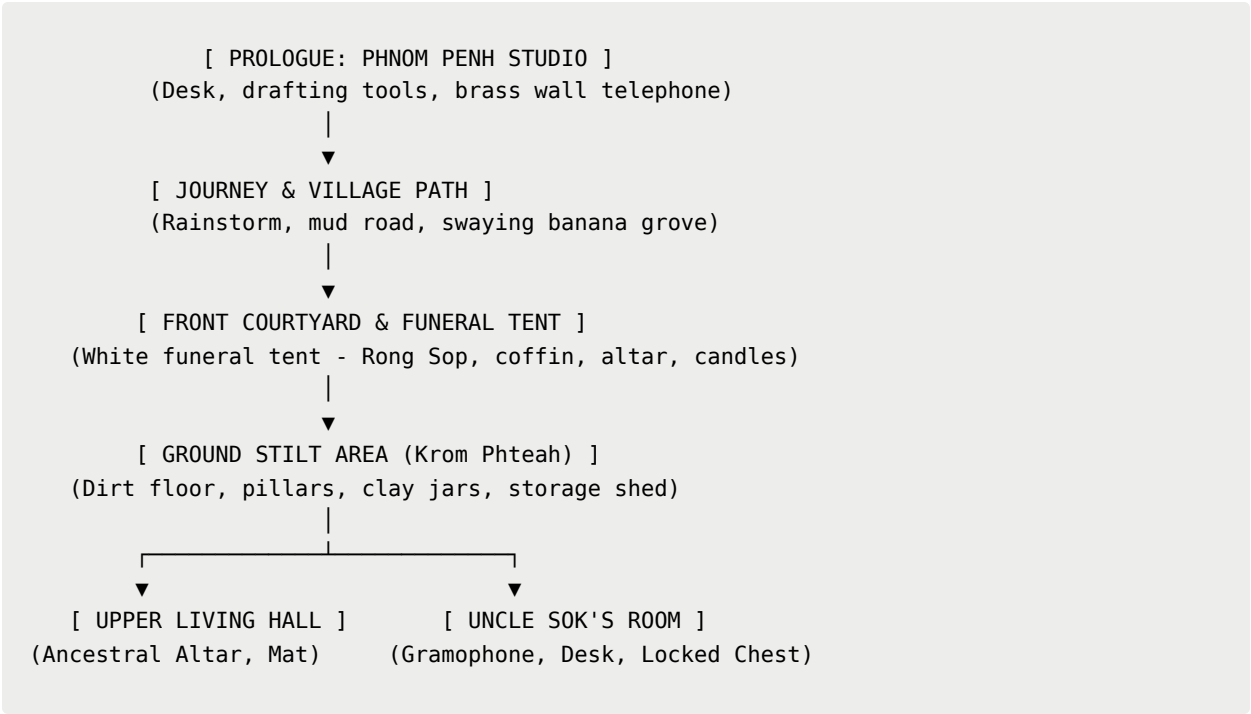
2. Character Profiles

- **Sora (ស□ខ□□◌̈□):** Independent, creative, and educated. She left her rural village years ago to pursue her design career in Phnom Penh. She carries her leather drafting satchel containing her sketchbook, fountain pens, brass matches, and hurricane lamp.
- **Uncle Sok (□□□ - Deceased):** Sora's estranged uncle who lived alone in the family's ancestral stilt house. Known in the village as an eccentric collector of ancient manuscripts and relics.

Episode 1: The House of Mourning (□□□□□□□□□)
1

- **Grandmother Yay Mey (□□□□□□ - Age 78):** The matriarch of the family. Traditional, strict, and deeply superstitious. Wears a traditional white mourning *Chong Kben* and silk sash (*Sbai*).
- **The Entity (Neak Ta Manifestation):** A towering, shadow-wrapped figure wearing a distorted ancient brass mask, appearing as a dark silhouette that shifts position inside or near the coffin when unobserved.

3. Environment & Spatial Layout



1. Phnom Penh Studio (Prologue)

- Cozy third-floor apartment in 1930s Phnom Penh.
- Props: Wooden drafting table, ink bottles, typography prints, green glass desk lamp, wall-mounted brass hand-crank telephone, and a mechanical wall clock stopping at 8:12 PM.

2. Exterior: Courtyard & White Funeral Tent (*Rong Sop*)

- **Structure:** A bamboo-framed open tent draped in coarse, wet white cotton cloth fluttering in the storm wind.

- **Props**:Elevated wooden stage holding the decorated teak coffin (*Mneang Sop*).Framed black-and-white portrait photo of Uncle Sok on a small altar with brass candle holders.Four tall brass incense burners positioned at the four corners of the coffin.Woven bamboo benches, clay water jars (*Pheon*), and protective white cotton thread (*Sai Sin*) tied along the bamboo frame.
- **Lighting:** Warm, flickering glow from hanging glass oil lamps (*Chhenglang*) and thick yellow wax candles against pitch-black night shadows.

3. Interior: Upper Teak Stilt House (*Phteah Rong Doeung*)

- **Architecture:** Constructed from dark teak wood with 1 cm gaps between floorboards. High-gabled roof lined with terracotta tiles.
- **Main Living Hall:** Large woven bamboo mat (*Kanteal*), ancestral altar holding small bronze statues, and betel nut trays.
- **Uncle Sok's Room:** Cluttered desk with fountain pens, stacks of dried palm-leaf manuscripts (*Sleok Rith*), an old brass-horn Gramophone, and a heavy iron-bound wooden chest hidden behind loose wall planks.

4. Ground Area: Under-House Stilt Base (*Krom Phteah*)

- Open-air dirt floor underneath the elevated living space, surrounded by large wooden pillars. Stacked firewood, ox-cart wheels, clay water jars, and a locked wooden storage shed at the back.

4. Act Breakdown & Detailed Narrative

Prologue: The Call in Phnom Penh (0:00 – 0:25)

Narrative Narrative

Sora is working late on an illustration commission in her Phnom Penh studio while a tropical rainstorm rages outside. Suddenly, an unexplainable feeling of dread grips her. Her hands tremble, spilling ink across her sketchbook. A candle on her shelf flickers out, and her wall clock stops dead at 8:12 PM.

The brass wall telephone rings sharply. Sora answers and hears her Grandmother's panicking voice through heavy static:

> *"Sora... you must come home right now... Uncle Sok... he broke it... it's inside the house—"*

A screech cuts through the line, followed by the sound of glass shattering and heavy thuds. Horrified, Sora drops the brass earpiece, leaving it dangling on its cord broadcasting dead static.

Gameplay Mechanics & Tutorial

- Basic Movement & Interaction: Player learns controls inside the studio (picking up items, opening drawers).
- Inventory Collection: Player collects her leather satchel, sketchbook, brass matchbox, and kerosene hurricane lamp before rushing out into the storm.

Act I: Arrival & The Vigil (0:25 – 1:15)

Narrative Narrative

After an overnight train ride and horse carriage journey through the storm, Sora arrives at her family's village at 11:30 PM. The carriage driver refuses to go down the muddy road, forcing Sora to walk the final stretch through swaying banana groves with her lit hurricane lamp.

She enters the courtyard to find the white funeral tent (*Rong Sop*) erected in front of her family's stilt house. Her grandmother, Yay Mey, greets her in tears. Exhausted from two days of mourning, Yay Mey asks Sora to take the late-night watch over Uncle Sok’s body and gives her three sacred duties:

1. Keep her hurricane lamp filled with kerosene oil.
2. Ensure the four corner incense sticks around the coffin never burn out.
3. Verify that the protective white thread (*Sai Sin*) around the tent remains unbroken.

Gameplay Mechanics & Puzzles

- Resource Management: Kerosene lamp oil meter (player must search the house for spare oil bottles).
- Diegetic Sketchbook: Clues, maps, and ancient runes are automatically drawn in Sora's sketchbook as she investigates.

- The Incense Loop: Every 10–12 minutes, the incense sticks burn down. Sora must retrieve fresh sticks from the house altar to replenish them, or the ambient lighting darkens and disturbing whispers intensify.

Act II: The Unbroken Taboo (1:15 – 2:30)

Narrative Narrative

At 1:00 AM, a sudden cold gust of wind blows out the hanging oil lamps under the funeral tent. Sora hears heavy, wet footsteps echoing across the wooden floorboards *inside* the house above.

Investigating upstairs, Sora finds Uncle Sok’s room door ajar. Hidden behind a loose wall plank, she finds pages from Uncle Sok’s 1931 personal journal. The entries reveal that Uncle Sok didn't die of illness—he attempted a forbidden ritual to break an ancestral pact made by Sora's great-grandfather in 1910 with a land guardian spirit (*Neak Ta*). Uncle Sok failed to bind the entity, causing it to strike him down.

Gameplay Mechanics & Puzzles

- The Gramophone Puzzle: A brass-horn gramophone in Uncle Sok's room begins playing a backward funeral chant on its own. Sora must adjust the governor speed dial to reveal a spoken clue indicating where the desk drawer key is hidden.
- Audio Stealth: While exploring upstairs, dragging footsteps sound in the hallway. Sora must extinguish her hurricane lamp and hide behind wooden wardrobes until the shadow passes the doorway.
- The Altered Photo: Returning downstairs, all four corner incense sticks have turned to white ash. The framed photo of Uncle Sok on the altar has changed —his eyes in the portrait are now open and staring directly at Sora.

Act III: The First Seal (2:30 – 3:30)

Narrative Narrative

A violent *SNAP* echoes across the yard—the main *Sai Sin* white thread snaps in half. Darkness creeps inward as ambient oil lamps go out one by one. Inside the coffin, Uncle Sok’s corpse shifts position whenever Sora turns her back.

Guided by translated journal pages, Sora realizes she must find the Bronze Token of the Neak Ta locked inside the under-house storage shed to perform a counter-ritual before 3:00 AM.

Gameplay Mechanics & Puzzles

- Under-House Search: Sora explores the pitch-black dirt area under the house (*Krom Phteah*). Using spatial 3D audio, she dodges a roaming shadow entity while collecting three missing brass key fragments hidden inside clay water jars.
- Unlocking the Chest: Sora returns upstairs to unlock the iron-bound chest using the assembled key, retrieving the Bronze Token of the Neak Ta (Seal #1) and a map showing four other locations marked across Cambodia.
- The Counter-Ritual & Climax: Sora brings the Bronze Token to the coffin altar, places it into the main incense burner, and lights it with sanctified matches while reciting the counter-mantra. The entity manifests directly behind her, casting a massive shadow across the white tent fabric. Sora must complete the lighting sequence under intense visual/audio pressure without turning around.

Episode Resolution & Cliffhanger

As the token burns, a blast of wind tears through the white tent. The entity releases an echoing screech that fades into the night. Sunlight breaks softly over the banana groves as 4:00 AM approaches.

The curse on the house is temporarily broken, and Uncle Sok's corpse settles peacefully. However, as Sora opens her sketchbook, a fresh line of dark blood bleeds across the paper map, pointing directly toward the village pagoda—setting up **Episode 2: The Whispering Pagoda.**

5. Audio & Visual Specification Sheet

Feature	Design Specification
Color Palette	Sepia, dark mahogany, warm amber flame orange, cold off-white linen, wet mud grey.
Post-Processing	1930s film grain filter, chromatic aberration, lens vignetting, dynamic WebGL shadow mapping.

Feature	Design Specification
Light Sources	Kerosene hurricane lamp (held by Sora), hanging glass oil lamps, wax candles, moonlight.
Primary Ambience	Heavy rain, thunder rolls, night cicadas, bullfrogs, creaking teak wood.
Horror Sound Cues	Backward gramophone music, mechanical clock chimes, snapping thread, heavy dragging steps.
UI Design	100% Diegetic (no on-screen HUD). Oil gauge visible on the lamp; inventory and map accessed through Sora's physical sketchbook satchel.